

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Pharmacy Technician English



Conversation lab

8 complete workplace dialogues, followed by eight additional role-play cases. Study the exchanges, then make the conversation your own.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Pharmacy technicians and pharmacy support staff.

All patients, orders, amounts, times, and incidents are fictional language-practice examples, not medication, insurance, legal, dispensing, or technical training. Duties and supervision vary by jurisdiction and workplace. Pharmacists and other qualified professionals make clinical and regulated decisions. These exercises do not authorize dispensing, transfers, substitutions, handling methods, or changes to medication instructions.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Inside this conversation lab

Original fictional training conversations in professional English. These are realistic scripts, not transcripts of actual people. The professional roles are the speaker labels; all figures, incidents, and organizations are invented.

01 Correcting the word confirmed

02 Three statuses in one call

03 Which prescription needs renewing?

04 A supplier revises its estimate

05 A consultation needs language support

06 Permission for a conversation is not every permission

07 An expiry-date query in a delivery record

08 A correction must reach the listener

Then try eight independent role-play cases, followed by feedback criteria and references.

Read it. Hear it. Make it yours.

1. Read the setting. Identify the roles, the immediate problem, and what each speaker needs.
2. Read the whole conversation aloud with a partner. In a group, give a third person the observer role. For three-speaker scripts, assign each professional a separate voice.
3. Notice how the speakers ask a specific question, qualify a claim, disagree, explain a technical point, or agree on a next step. Underline language you would actually use.
4. Cover the script. Recreate the exchange using the situation and professional roles. Keep the meaning, but change the wording.
5. Switch roles and introduce a complication: a missing record, a different priority, an unavailable colleague, or a changed assumption. End with a clear outcome or unresolved question.

Register and terminology

These colleagues use concise professional language. In an internal technical meeting, familiar abbreviations can be natural. With a new colleague or a client, expand unfamiliar terms and check understanding. Keep disagreement directed at the evidence or proposal, and match the degree of certainty to what is known.

Independent study

Speak each role aloud. Pause before the reply and supply your own response before revealing the next line. Record a second version using invented details, then compare its clarity and tone with the script.

Professional context

All patients, orders, amounts, times, and incidents are fictional language-practice examples, not medication, insurance, legal, dispensing, or technical training. Duties and supervision vary by jurisdiction and workplace. Pharmacists and other qualified professionals make clinical and regulated decisions. These exercises do not authorize dispensing, transfers, substitutions, handling methods, or changes to medication instructions.

FULL DIALOGUE 01 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

Correcting the word confirmed

Fictional pharmacist handoff: a technician's note incorrectly calls a recalled strength confirmed.

Roles: Pharmacist / Technician

Pharmacist: Your note says the strength is confirmed, but the current order remains unclear. What was your source?

Technician: The patient remembered an earlier label. I used confirmed when I should have written patient reported.

Pharmacist: Has that wording reached anyone else, and has the order moved beyond the clarification stage?

Technician: Leo read the note, but the order is still on hold. I haven't selected a strength.

Pharmacist: Please tell Leo the status directly. A corrected note alone may not change what he remembers.

Technician: I'll say the strength remains unresolved and explain that the patient supplied recollection, not a current instruction.

Pharmacist: Exactly. We can value that information without presenting it as the answer to the prescription query.

Technician: Should I describe the patient as unreliable? I don't want anyone to repeat my original mistake.

Pharmacist: No. The issue is our wording, not a judgment about the patient. Keep the source explicit.

Technician: Then my correction is: patient recalled previous supply; current strength awaits pharmacist clarification. Does that capture it?

Pharmacist: Yes. I'll take the clarification from here. Please confirm that Leo has heard the corrected status.

Technician: I have him on the internal line now; I'll correct the wording before he handles that order.

Notice the professional language

'Patient reported' identifies a source without certifying the information.

'Moved beyond the clarification stage' asks whether an inaccurate message has affected subsequent work.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 02 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

Three statuses in one call

Fictional billing handoff: approval is received, the claim is pending, and pharmacist review is unfinished.

Roles: Technician / Billing colleague

Technician: The update says approved, but the patient asked about payment and collection. Which approval has actually arrived?

Billing colleague: The plan's authorization approval arrived. The final claim is pending, and the pharmacist's review is unfinished.

Technician: Then I can report one completed step, but I still have two separate questions to answer.

Billing colleague: That's right. Approval does not establish a copayment or mean the prescription is ready to collect.

Technician: Last month's claim showed no patient share. Should I mention it when explaining today's unknown amount?

Billing colleague: Only as historical information if needed. Don't let that older amount sound like today's confirmed charge.

Technician: Can you give me the claim status at two thirty? I have agreed to call at three.

Billing colleague: Yes, I'll provide the status at two thirty, even if processing is still incomplete at that point.

Technician: I'll also ask the pharmacist about readiness. The patient shouldn't travel based only on a billing update.

Billing colleague: Please make the callback distinction explicit: three is our contact time, not a promise of completion.

Technician: My message will be: authorization approved; payment and pharmacist review pending; I will call again at three.

Billing colleague: That separates the stages clearly. I'll send you the current claim response before your agreed call.

Notice the professional language

Specify the object after 'approved': a coverage authorization is not dispensing readiness.

'Even if' preserves a contact commitment when the underlying result is uncertain.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 03 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

Which prescription needs renewing?

Fictional clinic callback about two different prescription references; no medicine instructions are discussed.

Roles: Technician / Clinic coordinator

Technician: I'm following up on renewal request R21. Your message mentions R12, which is a different prescription reference.

Clinic coordinator: Thanks for catching that. I have both requests open, and I quoted the older reference by mistake.

Technician: For R21, our record still shows no response. Does your message contain an answer for that request?

Clinic coordinator: No, it only acknowledges receipt of R21. The prescriber hasn't sent a decision to me yet.

Technician: Then I'll report receipt acknowledged, decision pending. I won't attach the older response to this request.

Clinic coordinator: Please keep the references separate. R12's message belongs to last month's request, not the current renewal.

Technician: The patient expects a status call at noon. Is there a confirmed response time I can relay?

Clinic coordinator: There isn't. I can check our message queue before noon, but that isn't a prescriber completion commitment.

Technician: Understood. Could you make any later message explicit about the reference, so our team can match it?

Clinic coordinator: Yes. I'll identify R21 in the subject and use our usual secure communication route for the details.

Technician: I'll leave today's renewal pending and tell the patient we have acknowledgment, not a new prescription.

Clinic coordinator: That's accurate. Thank you for checking the reference before treating my earlier message as an answer.

Notice the professional language

renewal request - A request to a prescriber for a new or renewed prescription authorization.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 04 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

A supplier revises its estimate

Fictional wholesaler call: Thursday replaces Tuesday as the predicted delivery date; the cause is unknown.

Roles: Technician / Wholesaler representative

Technician: Yesterday's update estimated Tuesday; today's says Thursday. Which date should I quote to our stock lead?

Wholesaler representative: Thursday is the current estimate. Tuesday has been superseded, and I can't confirm shipment at this stage.

Technician: Can you tell me whether the change concerns our entire order or only the line marked P7?

Wholesaler representative: Only P7 has changed. The other lines keep their existing statuses; please don't apply Thursday to all items.

Technician: Thanks. I also need to correct a patient-facing message that referred to Tuesday as if it were certain.

Wholesaler representative: Please describe Thursday as an estimate too. We don't have a carrier confirmation that would support stronger wording.

Technician: Is a supplier shortage confirmed as the cause, or would that be an inference?

Wholesaler representative: It would be an inference. The notice changes the date but doesn't give a verified cause.

Technician: I'll report the changed estimate and leave the cause unspecified. When is your next update?

Wholesaler representative: Our next scheduled stock update is tomorrow morning. It may still show the same estimate rather than dispatch.

Technician: I'll check then and ask the pharmacy team to correct the earlier collection expectation separately.

Wholesaler representative: That keeps the messages accurate: P7's estimate changed, its shipment remains unconfirmed, and other lines are unchanged.

Notice the professional language

'Superseded' means a newer update has replaced an earlier one.

'Only P7' limits the scope of a change and prevents an order-wide misunderstanding.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 05 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

A consultation needs language support

Fictional pharmacy arranges an interpreter for a label discussion; no medicine advice is supplied.

Roles: Patient / Technician

Patient: I can manage payment in English, but I need language support for the pharmacist's explanation.

Technician: Thank you for telling me. Which language would you prefer for that discussion about your prescription label?

Patient: Arabic, please. My daughter is here, but I would prefer not to make her explain medical words.

Technician: I'll ask Ravi about the pharmacy's interpreter service. We can keep the payment details separate meanwhile.

Patient: Please tell him I understand the medicine name; the problem is the longer phrase on this label.

Technician: I'll identify that phrase as your question, without paraphrasing the advice or asking your daughter to translate it.

Patient: Will the interpreter join the pharmacist and me, or explain a message afterward?

Technician: Ravi will confirm the arrangement. Our service contact is checking availability now; no start time is confirmed.

Patient: I can wait for a status update, but I need to leave before the school pickup.

Technician: I'll include that timing constraint. Ravi has accepted the consultation and will discuss the available support with you.

Patient: That's useful. I don't want a quick answer I might misunderstand just because people are waiting.

Technician: The consultation counter is available for your privacy. Let's take the label question there when Ravi joins you.

Notice the professional language

'I can manage X, but I need support for Y' states a precise language need.

'Availability is being checked' avoids presenting a requested interpreter as already connected.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 06 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

Permission for a conversation is not every permission

Fictional patient invites a sibling into a pharmacist conversation but asks about separate future collection arrangements.

Roles: Patient / Technician

Patient: I'd like my brother present for the pharmacist's explanation, but I have another privacy question.

Technician: Please tell me the question. We can ask Maya to clarify the arrangements before the conversation begins.

Patient: Does inviting him into today's discussion automatically let him collect every prescription for me in future?

Technician: We shouldn't treat those as the same arrangement. Today's discussion and future collection require their own clarification.

Patient: Good. I want his help today, but haven't decided about future collections or telephone updates.

Technician: I'll tell Maya exactly that distinction. I won't describe your request as unrestricted permission for other matters.

Patient: Can you also avoid changing my contact preference to his number just because he's with me?

Technician: Yes. Your request concerns today's conversation; I have not changed the telephone number on your profile.

Patient: He may ask questions during the discussion. I want to be included rather than have everyone talk around me.

Technician: I'll pass that on too: you want his support, with the pharmacist continuing to address you directly.

Patient: That captures it. I'd like to discuss any future collection arrangement separately when we have more time.

Technician: Maya is ready to join us. I'll introduce today's request and leave those future arrangements explicitly undecided.

Notice the professional language

contact preference - A patient's recorded choice about suitable ways to communicate with them.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 07 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

An expiry-date query in a delivery record

Fictional stock documentation discussion; a scanned date is unclear and no product-use decision is made.

Roles: Technician / Stock lead

Technician: The delivery scan makes the expiry date difficult to read. One digit could be three or eight.

Stock lead: Which source are you looking at: the supplier's digital record or a photograph of the package?

Technician: A photograph attached to delivery E9. The image is blurred where the last digit appears.

Stock lead: Then we need a legible source, not an interpretation of the blur. I'll take the verification.

Technician: Could you also confirm whether the date belongs to E9 rather than the adjacent line?

Stock lead: Yes. The line association matters as much as the digit. Neither detail is confirmed yet.

Technician: The receiving note calls it expired. I think that wording goes beyond what the image shows.

Stock lead: Agreed. Report the unclear date and my pending check; don't substitute a different definite quality claim.

Technician: I'll tell the colleague who used expired that the source is unreadable, not proof of expiry.

Stock lead: Please do. We need everyone using the same status while I review the package information.

Technician: I'll leave the use decision with you and identify the photograph as the source of the uncertainty.

Stock lead: That is enough for this handoff: delivery E9, unclear date, line association unconfirmed, and my review pending.

Notice the professional language

expiry date - The labeled date beyond which a product is not to be used under its stated conditions.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 08 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

A correction must reach the listener

Fictional pharmacy debrief: an internal note was corrected, but a patient still has an inaccurate delivery date.

Roles: Pharmacist / Technician

Pharmacist: The record now says delivery unconfirmed. Has the patient heard that correction, or only the afternoon team?

Technician: Only the team. The patient still has my earlier message giving Friday as a definite date.

Pharmacist: Then the record is more accurate, but the communication problem remains. Who can contact the patient today?

Technician: I can, using the recorded preference. I'll identify my earlier wording rather than blame the supplier.

Pharmacist: What will you say if the patient asks whether the corrected date is now Saturday?

Technician: There isn't a confirmed replacement date. I'll say the Friday guarantee was wrong and arrival remains unconfirmed.

Pharmacist: Good. Please acknowledge that the patient may have arranged transport, without assuming whether they actually did.

Technician: I'll ask whether the message affected their plans and explain the next supplier-status check at noon tomorrow.

Pharmacist: Can you own tomorrow's update as well, or do we need a handoff before you leave?

Technician: I'm scheduled here tomorrow and can own it. I'll keep that contact separate from the stock enquiry.

Pharmacist: Then the outstanding tasks are today's correction call and tomorrow's update, not a promised delivery.

Technician: I'll make today's call now and record what was communicated, including any contact attempt that doesn't connect.

Notice the professional language

'Only the team' identifies who has received a correction and who has not.

'Remains unconfirmed' avoids replacing one inaccurate promise with another.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

Eight more situations to make your own

The following cases are open role plays. They give you facts, contrasting roles, useful expressions, and a short model response. Use what you learned from the complete dialogues to create a longer exchange.

Preparation: two minutes. Conversation: three to five minutes. Feedback: one minute. Switch roles and repeat with the second-round challenge.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 01

Prescription intake without assumptions

SHARED CASE

An order's strength field is unclear. The patient remembers a blue label and says their prescriber usually orders the same thing. The technician cannot select a strength. Pharmacist Maya can take the clarification; no completion time is known.

Role A | Responding professional

Identify an unclear prescription detail and explain who can clarify it. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Patient: your previous label was blue. You expect the same prescription, but cannot read the strength on today's order.

Useful expressions

The current prescription shows ___, but ___ is unclear.

You remember ___; we still need to confirm ___.

The order is awaiting ___, not ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

The current prescription's strength field is unclear. Your memory of the blue label gives us some background, but it does not confirm this order. Maya, our pharmacist, can handle the clarification. For now, the order is awaiting review; it has not been cancelled, and I cannot give you a collection time yet.

Second round

Ask whether awaiting clarification means the prescription has been cancelled.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 02

Insurance claims in plain English

SHARED CASE

The claim response says prior authorization required. No plan decision or accepted claim has arrived. The patient thinks this is a permanent exclusion. Billing colleague Inez has accepted the status query and can explain the request route.

Role A | Responding professional

Distinguish a coverage review, a claim response, and a patient's payment. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Patient: you believe a request for prior authorization means permanent exclusion. Ask who is handling the query.

Useful expressions

This response requires ____; it does not yet confirm ____.

The plan's review concerns ____, whereas the claim amount concerns ____.

The current claim shows ____; the previous amount was ____.

Cover this until after your first attempt

This response says prior authorization is required. That is a request for the plan's review, not the final coverage decision. We have neither an approval decision nor an accepted claim yet. Inez is handling the status query and can explain how the request proceeds; I cannot promise coverage or a final copayment.

Second round

Ask whether receiving an approval would automatically make the prescription free.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 03

Refill requests and response windows

SHARED CASE

The record shows no refills remaining. A renewal request was sent at 09:00 and has no response at 11:00. Technician Jo can call the patient between 15:00 and 16:00. No supply or prescriber response time is confirmed.

Role A | Responding professional

Separate the request sent, the response pending, and the next contact. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Patient: you expected a refill today and need to leave home at four.

Useful expressions

We sent ___ at ___; we are still awaiting ___.

The record shows ___ refills remaining.

I can call between ___ and ___ with the current status.

Cover this until after your first attempt

There are no refills remaining on this prescription. We sent a renewal request at nine, but no response is recorded as of eleven. I can call between three and four with the status. That is a callback window, not confirmation that the prescriber will respond or that a supply will be ready then.

Second round

Ask whether the pharmacy's message to the prescriber counts as the prescriber's permission.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 04

Stock enquiries and delivery estimates

SHARED CASE

The pharmacy has no stock for a patient's order. The wholesaler estimates Wednesday delivery, but shipment is not confirmed. Technician Lee can check the supplier update Tuesday at 16:00. The pharmacist handles questions about alternatives.

Role A | Responding professional

Report stock and delivery evidence without turning an estimate into a promise. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Patient: you want to arrange a Wednesday collection and assume estimated arrival means ready.

Useful expressions

The wholesaler estimates ___, but ___ is not confirmed.

We have confirmation of ___, not yet of ___.

Would you like the pharmacist to discuss ___?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Our pharmacy has no stock for this order today. The wholesaler estimates Wednesday delivery, but has not confirmed shipment, so Wednesday is not a collection promise. Lee will check the supplier update Tuesday at four. If you need to discuss alternatives or the effect of waiting, I can connect you with the pharmacist.

Second round

Ask whether another branch's online stock display guarantees that branch can supply your prescription.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 05

Pickup questions and pharmacist consultations

SHARED CASE

At pickup, patient Arden asks what an auxiliary label means. The technician can identify the label but cannot interpret the instruction. Pharmacist Ravi is available at the consultation counter and accepts the question. No instructions are changed.

Role A | Responding professional

Transfer a label question without giving medication advice. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Patient: you recognize the main label but want an additional warning explained.

Useful expressions

Your question is about ___ on the label.

I haven't interpreted ___; could you explain it with the patient?

___ has accepted the consultation at ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

Ravi, Arden has a question about the wording on this auxiliary label before collection. I have not interpreted it or changed any instructions. Could you take that question at the consultation counter? Arden, Ravi will explain the label with you; I will keep the pickup conversation separate from that medication guidance.

Second round

Ask the technician to give a quick answer because the queue is growing.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 06

Private collection and contact preferences

SHARED CASE

A person says they are collecting for their neighbor. Their collection authority has not been verified. They ask the technician to read out the neighbor's medicines to identify the right package. Lead pharmacist Maya can review the collection question privately.

Role A | Responding professional

Decline an unverified disclosure and offer a specific way to check collection arrangements. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Visitor: your neighbor asked you to help, but collection arrangements have not been checked.

Useful expressions

I can help with ___, but first we need to verify ___.

I can't discuss ___ with the current information.

___ can review the collection question privately.

Cover this until after your first attempt

I can help with the collection enquiry, but I cannot read out someone else's medicine details while their collection arrangements are unverified. Maya can review the required checks with you privately. Please tell her that you are here on your neighbor's behalf; I have not yet confirmed which information or package can be released.

Second round

Say that you have collected before and ask why today's enquiry needs checking.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 07

Precise inventory and quality queries

SHARED CASE

A fictional recall notice names lot AB41. The delivery record shows AB14, but the stock label has not been checked against the notice. Lead pharmacist Maya handles recall assessment. No affected status, patient exposure, or release decision has been established.

Role A | Responding professional

Ask for review of a concrete stock discrepancy without guessing its consequences. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Lead pharmacist: ask which two identifiers differ and what has actually been checked.

Useful expressions

The notice lists __; our record shows __.

Could you verify the complete __ against __?

I can confirm __, but not whether __.

Cover this until after your first attempt

Maya, could you compare the stock's complete lot number with this recall notice? The notice lists AB41, while the delivery record says AB14. I have not established whether the stock is affected. Please confirm who will assess the discrepancy and its release status; I will not describe these similar numbers as a match.

Second round

Ask whether the similar numbers prove a patient received affected stock.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 08

Corrected messages and shift handoffs

SHARED CASE

At 14:00 technician Jo told a patient the order was ready, misreading a queue entry. At 14:10 Jo confirms pharmacist review remains pending. The patient has started travelling. Jo owns a correction call now and a status call at 16:00; no collection time is known.

Role A | Responding professional

Correct an inaccurate status and make the next contact accountable. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Patient: you left home after hearing ready and want an explanation and a dependable update.

Useful expressions

I incorrectly said ____; the current status is ____.

I understand this meant ____ for you.

____ has accepted the outstanding task of ____.

Cover this until after your first attempt

I'm sorry I told you the order was ready at two. I misread the queue entry; pharmacist review is still pending, so that pickup message was incorrect. I understand you have already started travelling. I'll correct the record and call with the status at four, but I cannot confirm a collection time yet.

Second round

Ask for a guaranteed collection time to make up for the inconvenience.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

Lesson conversations and speaking practice

The following sections match 05 and 06 on the industry webpage and in the learner workbook. Each lesson has three ten-turn conversations and two bounded speaking scenarios. These are original fictional teaching scripts, not transcripts of real people.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The blue label does not settle the strength

Fictional counter exchange using the lesson case; pharmacist Maya is available.

01 • Patient: The last box had a blue label. Can't you use that to identify the strength?

02 • Technician: The current strength field is unclear. Label color doesn't confirm the detail we need.

03 • Patient: My prescriber usually orders the same thing. I've collected it here for years.

04 • Technician: That history helps explain your question, but Maya, our pharmacist, needs to handle this clarification.

05 • Patient: Does that mean you have cancelled today's prescription because I can't remember the number?

06 • Technician: No, it is awaiting clarification. Cancelled and awaiting clarification are different statuses in our record.

07 • Patient: Could Maya look at it? I don't want to lose my place by leaving.

08 • Technician: I'll give Maya the unclear order and your question. We have no collection time yet.

09 • Patient: Please tell her I can wait for an explanation, but not indefinitely today.

10 • Technician: Certainly. I'll include that in the handoff; please stay here while I speak with her.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

One letter apart

Fictional intake desk; two similar names appear, and neither record has been changed.

01 • Technician: Two similar patient profiles appear. Let's verify your details privately before selecting either record.

02 • Patient: Mine has an extra letter near the end. People often miss it when they type.

03 • Technician: Thank you. Please give your full name and date of birth here at this quieter counter.

04 • Patient: It's Elena Maren, born the fourteenth of June, nineteen eighty. Is that the same record?

05 • Technician: Those details match one profile. The other result has a different birth date.

06 • Patient: I moved recently, though. The address on that profile might still be my old one.

07 • Technician: We can check that separately. Which address should the registration team review with you?

08 • Patient: The address ending in Cedar Lane is old; my current address is on Willow Road.

09 • Technician: I'll mark the address question for review without joining the two similar profiles together.

10 • Patient: Good. I was worried the spelling difference meant all my prescriptions had disappeared.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Receipt before readiness

Fictional patient shows a received notification; the live record says pharmacist review pending.

01 • Patient: My phone says you received the prescription. I thought that meant I could collect it.

02 • Technician: That message confirms receipt. Today's record still shows pharmacist review pending, rather than ready for pickup.

03 • Patient: I have twenty minutes before work. Is that enough time for the review?

04 • Technician: I don't have a completion estimate. You don't need to stay just to keep it in the queue.

05 • Patient: Will the next notification actually say ready, or will it use the same wording?

06 • Technician: A pickup notification says ready. Please check that wording before making another trip.

07 • Patient: I changed my telephone number last month. Could that message go to the wrong number?

08 • Technician: Let's verify your contact preference privately. I won't read the number across the counter.

09 • Patient: The number ending in forty-two is current. Please check that one against my profile.

10 • Technician: It matches. The review is still pending, and the pickup notice will use that number.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Prescription intake without assumptions

An order's strength field is unclear. The patient remembers a blue label and says their prescriber usually orders the same thing. The technician cannot select a strength. Pharmacist Maya can take the clarification; no completion time is known.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Patient: your previous label was blue. You expect the same prescription, but cannot read the strength on today's order.

Second round: Ask whether awaiting clarification means the prescription has been cancelled.

Scenario 2 | A change discussed but not received

A patient remembers the prescriber discussing a different strength yesterday. The received order does not show that change. Pharmacist Maya is available; nobody has confirmed whether a revised order was sent.

Role A: Technician: identify the discrepancy without selecting either strength.

Role B: Patient: you remember a discussion, not the exact instruction or whether a new order was issued.

Possible opening: The prescriber said something would change, but this looks like my previous order.

Success checks

- Attribute the discussion to the patient's account.
- Name the difference between that account and the received order.
- Pass the question to Maya without choosing a strength or promising completion.

Add a complication: The patient asks you to describe the remembered discussion as a confirmed new prescription.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A requirement, not a final refusal

Fictional pharmacy counter using the prior-authorization case.

01 • Patient: The message says prior authorization required. Does that mean my plan will never cover this?

02 • Technician: This claim rejection requires a coverage review. We haven't received the plan's decision yet.

03 • Patient: So someone has approved it, but you haven't prepared the prescription for collection?

04 • Technician: No approval or accepted claim is showing. Preparation and collection are separate questions as well.

05 • Patient: Who can tell me what happens to the request? I keep hearing unfamiliar terms.

06 • Technician: Inez, our billing colleague, has accepted your query. She can explain the request route.

07 • Patient: Could she guarantee the plan will pay if the prescriber sends the information?

08 • Technician: No. Sending information and receiving approval are different stages; the decision belongs to the plan.

09 • Patient: Then please ask her where the request stands, not whether the medicine is ready.

10 • Technician: That's the question I'll pass on. The current response still says prior authorization required.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A friend's ten-dollar payment

Fictional accepted claim shows a twenty-dollar copayment; the patient mentions a friend's different plan.

01 • Patient: My friend pays ten dollars. Why does the amount on my receipt say twenty?

02 • Technician: Your current processed claim shows a twenty-dollar copayment. Your friend's amount doesn't establish yours.

03 • Patient: We use the same insurance company. I assumed that meant identical coverage for both of us.

04 • Technician: The company can administer different plans. A formulary listing can have different cost-sharing conditions.

05 • Patient: Is twenty an estimate, or is that what this particular claim actually returned?

06 • Technician: It's the amount returned for this claim. I can refer questions about how it was determined.

07 • Patient: I'd like that explanation before paying. I'm not asking you to choose a cheaper medicine.

08 • Technician: Understood. Inez can discuss the claim; medicine alternatives would be a question for the pharmacist.

09 • Patient: Could I speak to Inez away from the queue? I'd rather discuss the details privately.

10 • Technician: Yes. The consultation counter is free, and I'll tell her you're asking about this claim's copayment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The number on an old card

Fictional billing call: claim rejected because member information needs verification; acceptance is not guaranteed.

01 • Technician: This claim was rejected with a member-information message. The patient brought an older insurance card.

02 • Billing colleague: Does the profile match that card, or have you verified information for the current plan year?

03 • Technician: It matches the older card. The patient says a replacement arrived but hasn't shown it yet.

04 • Billing colleague: Then our immediate question is which membership information is current, not whether coverage is permanently excluded.

05 • Technician: Can you review the current card with the patient when they bring it this afternoon?

06 • Billing colleague: Yes. I can check those details and handle the claim query once the information is available.

07 • Technician: Should I promise acceptance after we update the number?

08 • Billing colleague: No, updating information doesn't guarantee acceptance. We need the response to the revised submission.

09 • Technician: I'll explain that today's rejection concerns this submission and that your review is the next step.

10 • Billing colleague: Please also ask them to bring the current card; that gives our conversation a concrete starting point.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Insurance claims in plain English

The claim response says prior authorization required. No plan decision or accepted claim has arrived. The patient thinks this is a permanent exclusion. Billing colleague Inez has accepted the status query and can explain the request route.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Patient: you believe a request for prior authorization means permanent exclusion. Ask who is handling the query.

Second round: Ask whether receiving an approval would automatically make the prescription free.

Scenario 2 | Approval without a payment amount

An authorization approval has arrived. The final claim has not been processed. Last month's patient share was zero, but today's amount is unknown. Inez handles payment queries.

Role A: Technician: explain what the approval establishes and what remains open.

Role B: Patient: you need to know whether to bring money when collecting.

Possible opening: Last month was free, and now you have approval, so today's supply is free too?

Success checks

- Separate listing, authorization, and processed payment.
- Avoid carrying forward last month's amount.
- Identify Inez as the contact for the remaining claim question.

Add a complication: The patient confuses a formulary listing with a confirmed zero copayment.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The nine o'clock request

Fictional refill call using the lesson case.

01 • Patient: I requested a refill this morning. Has my prescriber answered, or is it ready?

02 • Technician: There are no refills remaining. We sent a renewal request at nine; no response is recorded.

03 • Patient: It's eleven now. Does sending the request mean the prescriber has accepted it?

04 • Technician: No. Sending it confirms our action, not the prescriber's answer or permission for another supply.

05 • Patient: I have to leave home at four. Could someone call before I go?

06 • Technician: Jo's callback window is three to four. She'll report the status even if no answer arrives.

07 • Patient: Please don't leave me expecting a pickup message if the request is still pending.

08 • Technician: We'll call it a renewal update. Any collection readiness would need separate confirmation.

09 • Patient: What should I do about a medication question while I wait for that response?

10 • Technician: I can connect you to the pharmacist for that question now; the renewal status remains pending.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Two requests, one record

Fictional duplicate web and telephone refill requests; both refer to the same prescription.

01 • Technician: I see a web request and your telephone message for the same prescription number.

02 • Patient: I submitted the second one because I wasn't sure the website had worked this morning.

03 • Technician: Thank you for explaining. Are both requests for the same supply, rather than separate prescriptions?

04 • Patient: Yes, the number is the same. I don't want two orders or two charges.

05 • Technician: I'll flag the duplicate request for our queue review; I haven't confirmed two supplies or charges.

06 • Patient: Does that mean I need to cancel the original request and start from the beginning?

07 • Technician: No, we're checking the duplicate against the original. I won't ask you to submit another.

08 • Patient: The website still says received. Can you tell me which message I should follow?

09 • Technician: Use the update for this prescription number. I'll note that the second contact was a duplicate.

10 • Patient: That's helpful. I'll keep the number handy instead of sending another request through the website.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A trip is not a refill allowance

Fictional patient leaves Friday; record review is pending and pharmacist Ravi is available.

01 • Patient: I'm leaving Friday and would like to collect earlier than usual. Can you arrange that?

02 • Technician: I can pass the timing request to Ravi, our pharmacist. An earlier supply isn't confirmed.

03 • Patient: The label mentions refills remaining. Doesn't that mean any collection date is available to me?

04 • Technician: It shows a refill allowance, but it doesn't settle every timing or claim requirement.

05 • Patient: Could you tell Ravi I leave Friday morning, rather than saying I'm travelling soon?

06 • Technician: Yes, Friday morning is the useful detail. When would you be available for a call?

07 • Patient: Tomorrow afternoon is best. I don't need a promise, just an explanation of the options.

08 • Technician: I'll include that availability and ask Ravi to review the timing question with you.

09 • Patient: Should I make another refill request tonight if I haven't heard back by then?

10 • Technician: We already have your request. I'll add the travel details to it instead of creating another.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Refill requests and response windows

The record shows no refills remaining. A renewal request was sent at 09:00 and has no response at 11:00. Technician Jo can call the patient between 15:00 and 16:00. No supply or prescriber response time is confirmed.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Patient: you expected a refill today and need to leave home at four.

Second round: Ask whether the pharmacy's message to the prescriber counts as the prescriber's permission.

Scenario 2 | A missed callback

Jo agreed to call yesterday between three and four but did not. No renewal response has arrived. Jo can provide a new status call today at noon; the pharmacist can address medication concerns now.

Role A: Technician: acknowledge the missed contact and give the current status.

Role B: Patient: you stayed home expecting the call and want a reliable next contact.

Possible opening: I waited all afternoon yesterday; was the prescription ready and nobody told me?

Success checks

- Apologize for the missed callback specifically.
- Keep approval and readiness unconfirmed.
- Agree the noon contact and offer the pharmacist for medication questions.

Add a complication: The patient interprets an apology as confirmation that approval has arrived.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Wednesday is an estimate

Fictional stock enquiry using the lesson case.

01 • Patient: Someone mentioned Wednesday. Should I book a taxi now to collect my prescription then?

02 • Technician: Wednesday is the estimated arrival from our wholesaler. We have no stock and no shipment confirmation.

03 • Patient: So the wholesaler hasn't actually told you the package is on its way?

04 • Technician: That's correct. Lee will check the supplier's update Tuesday at four, when more information may appear.

05 • Patient: Could you call Wednesday a collection date if I promise to come late?

06 • Technician: No, coming later doesn't turn an estimate into confirmed arrival or prescription readiness.

07 • Patient: I'd like to discuss what the wait means for me, beyond the delivery question.

08 • Technician: I'll connect you with the pharmacist for that. I can't advise on medication choices myself.

09 • Patient: Please keep the stock update separate so I know whether to arrange transport.

10 • Technician: I will. For now, the taxi would be based on an unconfirmed delivery estimate.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Six assigned from ten requested

Fictional pharmacy supply call about a fictional nonclinical stock order; no patient allocation decisions.

01 • Technician: Our order lists ten units, but your update shows six. Which quantity is actually assigned?

02 • Wholesaler representative: Six units are allocated. The other four remain on backorder with no arrival estimate.

03 • Technician: Does six allocated mean six dispatched, or are they still awaiting your shipping confirmation?

04 • Wholesaler representative: They haven't dispatched yet. Allocation is confirmed; dispatch time isn't available on my screen.

05 • Technician: Please give me the order reference so our stock lead can match this update.

06 • Wholesaler representative: It's order W83. The six assigned units and four outstanding units are listed separately.

07 • Technician: I'll report those quantities separately. We don't have a patient collection promise attached to them.

08 • Wholesaler representative: That's helpful. A shipping notice will identify what actually leaves, not just what was requested.

09 • Technician: Could your next update retain that split rather than saying the whole order is progressing?

10 • Wholesaler representative: Yes. I'll keep the allocated quantity, outstanding quantity, and shipment status explicit for W83.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The branch display is not a reservation

Fictional customer sees online stock at another branch; no availability has been checked directly.

01 • Patient: Your website shows stock at the Riverside branch. Does that mean they're holding it for me?

02 • Technician: No, that display isn't a reservation. We haven't confirmed their current stock or your order arrangements.

03 • Patient: Could you check whether I should travel there? It's forty minutes each way.

04 • Technician: I can ask their pharmacy team about the stock enquiry and explain the travel concern.

05 • Patient: Would checking stock also move my prescription automatically from this branch to theirs?

06 • Technician: No. A stock enquiry and a prescription transfer are separate matters for the pharmacy teams.

07 • Patient: Then please ask about availability without cancelling anything here or promising them my collection.

08 • Technician: That's clear. I'll describe this as an availability enquiry, with no transfer confirmed.

09 • Patient: Can the pharmacist explain what options I have if the display is out of date?

10 • Technician: Yes. I'll include that question when I pass on the enquiry and the travel detail.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Stock enquiries and delivery estimates

The pharmacy has no stock for a patient's order. The wholesaler estimates Wednesday delivery, but shipment is not confirmed. Technician Lee can check the supplier update Tuesday at 16:00. The pharmacist handles questions about alternatives.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Patient: you want to arrange a Wednesday collection and assume estimated arrival means ready.

Second round: Ask whether another branch's online stock display guarantees that branch can supply your prescription.

Scenario 2 | A delivered parcel, no item confirmation

A wholesaler parcel arrived at 10:00, but the stock team has not confirmed whether it includes item P7. A patient has heard 'the delivery arrived.' Stock lead Lee can check the receipt list now.

Role A: Technician: explain the distinction between a parcel and a specific item.

Role B: Patient: you believe P7 must be inside and want a collection promise.

Possible opening: The delivery van just left, so mine is definitely here now, isn't it?

Success checks

- Acknowledge the parcel's arrival.
- Keep P7's receipt and prescription readiness separate.
- Request Lee's item-level confirmation without recommending an alternative medicine.

Add a complication: The wholesaler's earlier estimate mentioned P7 but no shipment list was confirmed.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A question before collection

Fictional pickup counter using the label-handoff case.

01 • Technician: You mentioned the auxiliary label, the extra label here. Which part would you like explained?

02 • Patient: I recognize the main instructions, but I don't understand what this additional warning means.

03 • Technician: Ravi, our pharmacist, can explain it at the consultation counter. I won't interpret the instruction.

04 • Patient: Could you tell him I'm asking about this label, not asking for a different medicine?

05 • Technician: Yes, I'll pass on that distinction. He has accepted the consultation and is waiting there.

06 • Patient: I feel awkward holding up the queue when everyone else seems ready to pay.

07 • Technician: The consultation counter gives you space for the question without having to discuss it here.

08 • Patient: Does talking to Ravi mean my instructions have changed, or will he explain this label?

09 • Technician: No instructions have changed. Ravi's counseling conversation will explain the label already attached.

10 • Patient: Then I'll speak with Ravi first. Please keep my collection question separate from the label discussion.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Tablet is not a strength

Fictional patient uses the word strength when asking about tablet versus liquid.

01 • Patient: I wanted the other strength, the liquid one. Is that what the prescription says?

02 • Technician: Do you mean the physical form, liquid instead of tablet, rather than the ingredient amount?

03 • Patient: Yes, I meant the form. I sometimes use the wrong word at the counter.

04 • Technician: That's called the dosage form. The current order lists tablets; I'll pass your question to the pharmacist.

05 • Patient: Could the pharmacist discuss my concern without you changing the order before that conversation?

06 • Technician: Certainly. I've identified the wording difference, but haven't requested or selected a replacement medicine.

07 • Patient: Please mention that I want to discuss the form, not increase or decrease anything.

08 • Technician: I'll use those words in the handoff. They make your request much clearer.

09 • Patient: Thank you. I was worried that saying other strength had already changed the record.

10 • Technician: It hasn't changed the order. I'll flag the form question for the pharmacist's discussion with you.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Two bags, two statuses

Fictional patient has one prescription ready and another awaiting pharmacist review.

01 • Patient: I received a ready message. Does that cover both prescriptions I asked about yesterday?

02 • Technician: The notice covers one prescription. The second prescription's dispensing status remains pharmacist review pending.

03 • Patient: Can you show me which reference is ready without saying the medicine names aloud?

04 • Technician: Yes, let's check the references here privately. The notice matches the number ending in eighteen.

05 • Patient: The other ends in twenty-three. I had assumed the message included everything under my name.

06 • Technician: It doesn't. I can confirm eighteen is ready; twenty-three has a separate pending status.

07 • Patient: I have a question about the pending one. Is the counter queue the right place?

08 • Technician: I'll ask the pharmacist to discuss that question with you at the consultation counter.

09 • Patient: Please don't mark both collected just because I've arrived for the first one.

10 • Technician: Understood. Each prescription retains its own status, and today's notice only confirms readiness for eighteen.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Pickup questions and pharmacist consultations

At pickup, patient Arden asks what an auxiliary label means. The technician can identify the label but cannot interpret the instruction. Pharmacist Ravi is available at the consultation counter and accepts the question. No instructions are changed.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Patient: you recognize the main label but want an additional warning explained.

Second round: Ask the technician to give a quick answer because the queue is growing.

Scenario 2 | An unopened leaflet question

Patient Kim has not collected a prescription and wants a phrase in its information leaflet explained. Pharmacist Ravi is free in five minutes. The technician cannot interpret the phrase; no medicine problem is reported.

Role A: Technician: identify the question and arrange the consultation.

Role B: Patient: ask whether the leaflet wording changes the main label instructions.

Possible opening: This leaflet uses different words from the label. Which should I follow?

Success checks

- Preserve both texts as the subject of the question.
- Avoid selecting or changing instructions.
- State the five-minute consultation availability without diagnosing a conflict.

Add a complication: Kim asks you to reconcile the two texts while Ravi finishes another consultation.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Collecting for a neighbor

Fictional counter enquiry using the lesson privacy case.

01 • Visitor: I'm collecting for my neighbor. Read me the medicine names and I'll recognize the right bag.

02 • Technician: I can help with collection, but I can't read those details before the arrangements are verified.

03 • Visitor: She trusts me with her shopping, and I've helped her collect things here before.

04 • Technician: I appreciate that. We still need to verify today's arrangement before treating you as an authorized representative.

05 • Visitor: Are you saying you think I'm lying about knowing her or helping her?

06 • Technician: No. I'm explaining the information boundary, not questioning your intentions or your relationship.

07 • Visitor: Who can check it without making me explain everything in front of this queue?

08 • Technician: Maya can review the collection question privately. I haven't confirmed any package or medicine details.

09 • Visitor: I'll speak with her. Please tell her I'm here on my neighbor's behalf.

10 • Technician: I will. She can establish the relevant collection arrangements without discussing the neighbor's medicines across the counter.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A shared telephone

Fictional patient updates contact preferences; a shared home telephone should receive neutral messages only.

01 • Technician: You asked us to review your contact preference. Is the home telephone still suitable?

02 • Patient: Yes, but several people answer it. Please don't leave medicine names in a message.

03 • Technician: Would you prefer a neutral request to call the pharmacy back on that number?

04 • Patient: Yes. I can return a call, but I don't want the household hearing prescription details.

05 • Technician: I'll record that preference through our profile update process. Is your mobile number still current?

06 • Patient: It is, though I don't check it during work. The home number is more reliable.

07 • Technician: Then I'll keep the number and the message preference distinct; changing one doesn't require changing both.

08 • Patient: Could you repeat what you've understood before we finish? I want the instruction to be clear.

09 • Technician: Use the home number for a neutral callback request, without medicine names.

10 • Patient: That's exactly what I meant. Please let the team see that preference when they contact me.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A louder voice would not help

Fictional patient requests a quieter counter instead of having details repeated publicly.

01 • Patient: I didn't hear the question, but please don't repeat my details louder across the counter.

02 • Technician: Of course. The side counter is free; we can continue there with more privacy.

03 • Patient: Thank you. I have difficulty hearing when several conversations are happening at once.

04 • Technician: Would speaking clearly at the quieter counter help, or would you prefer another available communication method?

05 • Patient: The quieter space should help. I just need you to face me when speaking.

06 • Technician: We'll continue identity verification there without announcing private information. Confidentiality matters throughout the conversation.

07 • Patient: Will moving aside mean I lose my place and need to join the queue again?

08 • Technician: No, I'm continuing your enquiry with you. We are simply changing where the conversation happens.

09 • Patient: That's reassuring. I didn't want to choose between hearing the question and keeping things private.

10 • Technician: Let's move now. I'll repeat the question clearly once we're at the side counter.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Private collection and contact preferences

A person says they are collecting for their neighbor. Their collection authority has not been verified. They ask the technician to read out the neighbor's medicines to identify the right package. Lead pharmacist Maya can review the collection question privately.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Visitor: your neighbor asked you to help, but collection arrangements have not been checked.

Second round: Say that you have collected before and ask why today's enquiry needs checking.

Scenario 2 | A changed contact number

A patient says the number on their profile belongs to an old employer. No new number has been verified. They can review contact information at the private counter now; no contact attempt has been made today.

Role A: Technician: acknowledge the outdated information and arrange its review.

Role B: Patient: ask whether the pharmacy already contacted the old employer today.

Possible opening: Please don't use that number; I no longer work there.

Success checks

- State that no contact attempt has been made today.
- Avoid claiming what happened on other dates.
- Confirm the contact update through the private review.

Add a complication: The patient assumes an old number proves that private information was disclosed today.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

AB41 or AB14

Fictional stock-room communication using the recall-identifier case; no handling procedure is enacted.

01 • Technician: The recall notice names AB41, but our delivery record shows AB14. Could you check the difference?

02 • Pharmacist: Yes. Have you compared the complete identifier on the stock label with the notice yet?

03 • Technician: Not yet. I noticed the record difference and brought both references to you first.

04 • Pharmacist: Then affected status isn't established. I'll take the assessment and check the relevant stock record.

05 • Technician: Should I tell the counter team that our entire delivery has been recalled?

06 • Pharmacist: No, that would go beyond the information. Tell them I'm assessing this specific identifier discrepancy.

07 • Technician: The two numbers are easy to reverse when spoken. Shall I repeat them separately?

08 • Pharmacist: Please do, and name the source before each one so I can distinguish them.

09 • Technician: Notice lot number: AB41. Delivery record: AB14. No stock-label match or release decision is confirmed.

10 • Pharmacist: That is clear. I own the assessment; keep the status as under review until I report back.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A damaged carton

Fictional visible outer-carton damage is reported; contents and product suitability have not been assessed.

01 • Technician: The outer carton on delivery D6 is dented. I haven't assessed the contents.

02 • Stock lead: Thanks. Is the dent on every carton in the delivery or only one?

03 • Technician: Only the carton beside the delivery note. The others haven't been included in my observation.

04 • Stock lead: I'll review that item under our quality procedure. Please don't describe the whole delivery as damaged.

05 • Technician: Should I call the product unusable in the stock enquiry, or is that premature?

06 • Stock lead: That's not established. Say visible outer-carton damage, product assessment pending, and identify D6.

07 • Technician: The supplier asks for a description. May I quote those observed facts to them?

08 • Stock lead: Yes, use the agreed supply contact and keep the description limited to what you saw.

09 • Technician: I'll report one dented outer carton, not a damaged medicine or a confirmed cause.

10 • Stock lead: Good. I will communicate the stock decision after assessment so the team knows the actual status.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A count with a defined scope

Fictional inventory query: shelf count is twelve, system shows fourteen; no cause established.

01 • Technician: My count shows twelve units on this shelf, while the inventory screen shows fourteen.

02 • Stock lead: Did you include quarantined stock in the separate area, or only this shelf?

03 • Technician: Only this shelf. I haven't checked whether the screen includes stock in another location.

04 • Stock lead: Then we have a count difference to investigate, not evidence that two units are missing.

05 • Technician: Could you confirm the scope of the system total before I describe the discrepancy?

06 • Stock lead: Yes. I'll check the locations included and compare them with your count record.

07 • Technician: Should I change the total to twelve while you are looking into it?

08 • Stock lead: No adjustment has been approved. Keep the observation and the system total separate for review.

09 • Technician: I'll describe twelve counted on this shelf against fourteen shown, with location scope unresolved.

10 • Stock lead: That gives us a useful starting point without assuming loss, theft, or a counting error.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Precise inventory and quality queries

A fictional recall notice names lot AB41. The delivery record shows AB14, but the stock label has not been checked against the notice. Lead pharmacist Maya handles recall assessment. No affected status, patient exposure, or release decision has been established.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Lead pharmacist: ask which two identifiers differ and what has actually been checked.

Second round: Ask whether the similar numbers prove a patient received affected stock.

Scenario 2 | Stock present but unavailable

The screen shows eight units physically present, all marked quarantined pending pharmacist assessment. A colleague asks whether eight means eight available for a patient order. No release decision exists.

Role A: Technician: explain the difference between physical count and available inventory.

Role B: Colleague: you saw only the total and need a clear availability message.

Possible opening: There are eight on the screen, so can I say we have stock available?

Success checks

- State both quantity and quarantine status.
- Avoid making a product-quality conclusion.
- Refer the release-status question to the pharmacist.

Add a complication: The colleague treats quarantined as another shelf location with no effect on availability.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Correcting a premature pickup call

Fictional telephone correction using the lesson case.

01 • Technician: I'm calling to correct my two o'clock message. I incorrectly told you the order was ready.

02 • Patient: I'm already on the bus because of that call. What is the actual situation?

03 • Technician: Pharmacist review is still pending. I misread the queue entry, and I'm sorry for the unnecessary trip.

04 • Patient: Can you at least guarantee it will be ready by the time I arrive?

05 • Technician: No. I can't guarantee that while pharmacist review is still pending.

06 • Patient: Then tell me what you can commit to, because I need to plan my afternoon.

07 • Technician: I'll correct the message record and call with the status at four, whether or not review is complete.

08 • Patient: Please use my mobile for that call. I won't be at home to answer.

09 • Technician: I'll use the verified mobile on your profile. Four is our update time, not confirmed collection.

10 • Patient: All right. I understand the correction, though I'm still disappointed about the wasted travel.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A named owner at shift change

Fictional handoff: technician Jo hands an agreed callback to incoming technician Lee.

01 • Outgoing technician: I need to hand over the four o'clock status call for reference C8.

02 • Incoming technician: What remains open, and has the patient been told anything about a collection time?

03 • Outgoing technician: Review remains pending. I corrected an earlier ready message and made no new collection promise.

04 • Incoming technician: I can take the call. Is there a confirmed contact preference for this patient?

05 • Outgoing technician: Yes, the verified mobile on the profile. Please check the live status before calling.

06 • Incoming technician: So I own the four o'clock update, with readiness to be confirmed separately from that time.

07 • Outgoing technician: Exactly. The correction is recorded, but the promised callback itself hasn't happened yet.

08 • Incoming technician: I'll keep it open until I've made the contact or recorded the follow-up needed.

09 • Outgoing technician: Please don't close it simply because the correction note appears in the incident record.

10 • Incoming technician: Understood. I accept the callback, and I'll leave a clear contact outcome for the next shift.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Caught before the label left the desk

Fictional training discussion: a wrong-profile draft label was noticed before use; nothing was supplied.

01 • Technician: I caught the adjacent-profile draft label before it left the desk.

02 • Pharmacist: Thanks for reporting it. Was the label used, or was anything supplied to a patient?

03 • Technician: Neither happened. I stopped at the draft stage and brought the profile mismatch to you.

04 • Pharmacist: We'll review it through our reporting process. Describe what occurred rather than guessing why it happened.

05 • Technician: May I call it a near miss, since the potential error was intercepted before reaching anyone?

06 • Pharmacist: That describes the interception, but the report still needs the exact facts and review.

07 • Technician: I'll identify the references and draft stage in the incident report, without copying private details elsewhere.

08 • Pharmacist: Use the reporting record, with its audit trail, rather than an informal note or personal message.

09 • Technician: I'll report the observed mismatch and its stage. I haven't established a cause yet.

10 • Pharmacist: I'll take the review. Make clear that no label was used and nothing supplied.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Corrected messages and shift handoffs

At 14:00 technician Jo told a patient the order was ready, misreading a queue entry. At 14:10 Jo confirms pharmacist review remains pending. The patient has started travelling. Jo owns a correction call now and a status call at 16:00; no collection time is known.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Patient: you left home after hearing ready and want an explanation and a dependable update.

Second round: Ask for a guaranteed collection time to make up for the inconvenience.

Scenario 2 | A sent message without acceptance

Jo sent Lee a message asking for a 15:00 callback, but Lee has not acknowledged it and is unavailable. Jo remains on duty until 14:30; shift lead Maya can allocate the call. No prescription outcome is confirmed.

Role A: Jo: explain why the callback still lacks an accepted owner.

Role B: Maya: ask about the agreed time and arrange ownership without marking the call completed.

Possible opening: The message went to Lee, but nobody has accepted the three o'clock call yet.

Success checks

- Distinguish message delivery from task acceptance.
- State the existing callback time.
- Obtain an explicit owner while keeping the contact task open.

Add a complication: A colleague says a sent message is enough to close the task.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All patients, orders, amounts, times, and incidents are fictional language-practice examples, not medication, insurance, legal, dispensing, or technical training. Duties and supervision vary by jurisdiction and workplace. Pharmacists and other qualified professionals make clinical and regulated decisions. These exercises do not authorize dispensing, transfers, substitutions, handling methods, or changes to medication instructions.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics: Pharmacy Technicians

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/healthcare/pharmacy-technicians.htm>

Pharmacy Technician Certification Board: Certified Pharmacy Technician

<https://ptcb.org/credentials/certification/certified-pharmacy-technician/>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Rehearse with an AI colleague

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Pharmacy Technician English

Professional audience: Pharmacy technicians and pharmacy support staff

Scope: All patients, orders, amounts, times, and incidents are fictional language-practice examples, not medication, insurance, legal, dispensing, or technical training. Duties and supervision vary by jurisdiction and workplace. Pharmacists and other qualified professionals make clinical and regulated decisions. These exercises do not authorize dispensing, transfers, substitutions, handling methods, or changes to medication instructions.

Dialogue 01: Correcting the word confirmed

Original fictional setting: Fictional pharmacist handoff: a technician's note incorrectly calls a recalled strength confirmed.

Professional roles: Pharmacist / Technician

Published dialogue (reference script, not my own performance):

Pharmacist: Your note says the strength is confirmed, but the current order remains unclear. What was your source?

Technician: The patient remembered an earlier label. I used confirmed when I should have written patient reported.

Pharmacist: Has that wording reached anyone else, and has the order moved beyond the clarification stage?

Technician: Leo read the note, but the order is still on hold. I haven't selected a strength.

Pharmacist: Please tell Leo the status directly. A corrected note alone may not change what he remembers.

Technician: I'll say the strength remains unresolved and explain that the patient supplied recollection, not a current instruction.

Pharmacist: Exactly. We can value that information without presenting it as the answer to the prescription query.

Technician: Should I describe the patient as unreliable? I don't want anyone to repeat my original mistake.

Pharmacist: No. The issue is our wording, not a judgment about the patient. Keep the source explicit.

Technician: Then my correction is: patient recalled previous supply; current strength awaits pharmacist clarification. Does that capture it?

Pharmacist: Yes. I'll take the clarification from here. Please confirm that Leo has heard the corrected status.

Technician: I have him on the internal line now; I'll correct the wording before he handles that order.

Vocabulary in this exchange: prescription: An order for a medicine issued by a prescriber, subject to the pharmacy's required checks. / strength: The amount of active ingredient in a specified unit or concentration of a medicine.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Interactive workplace role-play

1. Use the supplied case or dialogue as the starting situation. Give a two-sentence briefing and offer two relevant professional roles for me to choose from. For a supplied dialogue, use its actual roles. Ask which role I want, then stop and wait. Do not write my replies.
 2. After I choose, identify who you will play and the immediate communication goal. Play the other professional; where a meeting requires a third person, label each of your speakers clearly. Start with one natural workplace turn and wait for my reply. Keep most turns to one to three sentences and ask no more than one question at a time.
 3. Let the exchange develop across six to ten learner turns, or end earlier if I type "feedback". Respond to what I actually say. Include a plausible clarification, disagreement or tradeoff without silently changing the starting facts. Mark any added constraint as a fictional second-round variation. Do not resolve approvals, evidence or commitments that remain uncertain.
 4. Stay in role during the exchange. If my meaning is unclear, ask for clarification naturally. Give a hint only if I ask or cannot proceed. Do not deliver a model conversation in advance.
 5. At the debrief, quote two of my phrases: one successful choice and one worth improving. Check factual accuracy, language, register and whether the next step was clear. Give up to three focused suggestions. Ask me to retry the weakest turn; wait. Only then offer an alternative wording and a harder replay.
- Use voice replies when available. If I prefer selections, offer four plausible spoken replies and explain my choice before continuing. Do not require written compositions.

END PROMPT

Create more scenario dialogues

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

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When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

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Vocabulary in this exchange: prescription: An order for a medicine issued by a prescriber, subject to the pharmacy's required checks. / strength: The amount of active ingredient in a specified unit or concentration of a medicine.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Extend the conversation library

1. Propose six distinct, common scenarios in this field beyond the supplied case or script. For each, name the setting, two or more professional roles, the communication problem and one useful terminology focus. Include routine coordination, clarification, a complication, disagreement, handoff and follow-up where relevant. Choose scenarios that fit this profession, rather than forcing unsuitable situations into it.
2. Ask me to choose one scenario, or request all six in sequence. Stop and wait. Do not write all the scripts before I choose.
3. For the selected scenario, write an original fictional dialogue of 12-18 substantial speaking turns between two or three professionals. Name each role, establish an actual work problem, and let the exchange progress through questions, clarification, competing constraints and a credible next step or explicitly unresolved issue. Use the occupation's natural nomenclature and register. Avoid an interview between a teacher and a learner, generic small talk, and inserting a glossary definition into every reply. Explain specialist terms outside the dialogue instead.
4. After the script, explain five useful expressions in context, identify two grammar or register choices and ask three questions about the speakers' reasoning. Withhold the answers until I attempt them. Add one role-switch challenge.
5. Before presenting a script, check names, numbers, chronology, roles and terminology for consistency. Label invented facts and acknowledge uncertain specialist usage. If I requested all six, deliver one complete script at a time and wait for "next". Make each scenario materially different.

END PROMPT